Botanical Survey of India

On 13 February 1890, a survey was formally constituted and designated as the Botanical Survey of India. After independence, the need was felt for a more comprehensive documentation of the country's plant resources to boost the economy. Padmashree **Dr.E.K.Janaki Ammal** was appointed as officer on special Duty on 14th Oct 1952. Then reorganization plan was finally approved by the Govt. of India on 29 March 1954, with Calcutta as the headquarters of BSI. Jammu Tavi Botanical Garden has been named after Dr. E. K. Janaki Ammal.



Figure 5.3: Dr. E.K. Janaki Ammal

expressing the relationship between the organisms.

Taxonomists have assigned a method of classifying organisms which are called **ranks.** These taxonomical ranks are hierarchical. The scheme of classification has to be flexible, allowing newly discovered living organisms to be added where they fit best.

5.9 Need for Classification

- Understanding the classification of organisms can give an insight into other fields and has significant practical value.
- Classification helps us to know about different taxa, their phylogenetic relationship and exact position.
- It helps to train the students of plant sciences with regard to the diversity of organisms and their relationship with other biological branches.

5.10 Types of classification

Taxonomic entities are classified in three ways. They are artificial classification, natural classification and phylogenetic classification.

5.10.1 Artificial system of classification

24 classes recognized by Linnaeus in his *Species Plantarum* (1753) on the basis of stamens.

No.	Classes	Characters
1	Monandria	stamen one
2	Diandria	stamens two
3	Triandria	stamens three
4	Tetrandria	stamens four
5	Pentandria	stamens five
	up to 24th class Cryptogamia	flowerless plants

Carolus Linnaeus (1707 -1778) was a great Swedish Botanist and said to be the "**Father of Taxonomy**." He outlined an artificial system of classification in "***Species Plantarum***" in 1753, wherein he listed and described 7,300 species and arranged in 24 classes mostly on the basis of number, union (adhesion and cohesion), length, and distribution of stamens. The classes were further subdivided on the basis of carpel characteristics into orders. Hence the system of classification is also known as **sexual system of classification**.



Figure 5.4: Carolus Linnaeus

This system of classification though artificial, was continued for more than 100 years after the death of Linnaeus, due to its simplicity and easy way of identification of plants.

However the system could not hold good due to the following reasons.

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